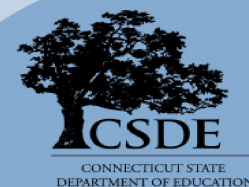


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



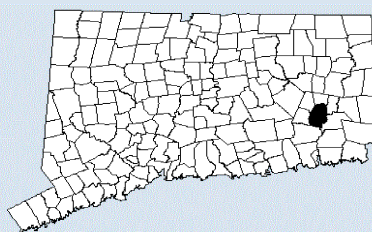
Norwich Free Academy District

Dr. Brian Kelly, Superintendent • 860-887-2505 • <http://www.nfaschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	9-12
Number of Schools/Programs	3
Enrollment	2,079
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	N/A
Total Expenditures ¹	N/A

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,084	52.1	48.5
Male	*	*	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	21	1.0	0.3
Asian	126	6.1	5.1
Black or African American	295	14.2	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	484	23.3	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	7	0.3	0.1
Two or More Races	110	5.3	4.3
White	1,036	49.8	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	204	9.8	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,068	51.4	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	264	12.7	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	317	29.8	155	13.7
Male	*	*	213	20.2
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	107	35.3	72	22.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	195	39.7	112	21.5
White	251	25.0	139	13.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	83	37.6	41	17.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	421	41.0	258	21.4
Students with Disabilities	104	39.0	80	26.5
District	628	30.4	368	16.9
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 687

Number of school-based arrests: 12

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	135.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	9.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	19.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	11.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	17.7
School Level	2.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	23.0
School Nurses	4.5
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	96.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.5	0.1
Asian	5	2.5	1.3
Black or African American	10	5.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	8	4.0	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	175	87.9	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.0	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	66	84.6	76	80.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	96	75.0	71	75.5
White	254	91.0	213	82.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	33	70.2	34	56.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	223	83.5	183	76.6
Students with Disabilities	59	83.1	44	77.2
District	465	85.8	409	80.5
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.1
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.3
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	N/A	N/A	\$12,000
Support services - students	N/A	N/A	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	N/A	N/A	\$780
Support services - general administration	N/A	N/A	\$472
Support services - school based administration	N/A	N/A	\$1,103
Central and other support services	N/A	N/A	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	N/A	N/A	\$1,910
Student transportation services	N/A	N/A	\$1,287
Food services	N/A	N/A	\$28
Enterprise operations	N/A	N/A	\$170
Total	N/A	N/A	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	N/A	N/A	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	N/A	N/A	10.8
Other Salaries	N/A	N/A	9.8
Employee Benefits	N/A	N/A	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	N/A	N/A	5.7
Special Education Tuition	N/A	N/A	22.6
Supplies	N/A	N/A	0.6
Property Services	N/A	N/A	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	N/A	N/A	6.3
Equipment	N/A	N/A	0.2
All Other Expenditures	N/A	N/A	0.1
Total	N/A	N/A	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		N/A	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	N/A
State	N/A
Federal	N/A
Tuition & Other	N/A

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	31	59.1	31	63.2	31	61.7
Black or African American	66	41.2	66	35.9	69	39.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	96	42.9	96	39.3	97	40.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	*	*	*	*	*	*
White	254	56.8	254	50.5	262	55.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	37	35.1	37	34.5	40	33.3
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	433	52.8	433	47.6	441	51.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	227	45.4	227	41.2	232	44.6
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	243	57.0	243	51.5	249	54.7
Students with Disabilities	55	36.9	55	33.0	57	34.6
Students without Disabilities	415	53.4	415	48.3	424	51.9
High Needs	245	45.0	245	40.7	255	43.4
Non-High Needs	225	58.4	225	52.9	226	57.1
District	470	51.4	470	46.5	481	49.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	N/A	77.2	404	77.2
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	65.6	404	65.6
Push Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	51.5	404	51.5
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	N/A	40.3	404	40.3
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	N/A	26.0	404	26.0
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	58	94.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	128	78.9
White	281	92.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	62	77.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	337	85.8
Students with Disabilities	67	70.1
District	576	89.6
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	96.8	184	34.7
Male	*	158	30.5
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	94.2	24	13.9
Hispanic or Latino	95.0	34	15.3
White	97.8	224	41.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	90.7	10	9.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	96.8	102	20.2
Students with Disabilities	85.9	*	*
District	96.6	342	32.6
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2022 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	66.4	77.8
Male	49.8	71.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	66.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	54.5	73.8
White	60.6	73.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	42.0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	51.0	65.2
Students with Disabilities	23.7	38.5
District	59.4	74.7
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	51.4	75	102.8	150	68.6	64.2
	High Needs Students	45.0	75	90.0	150	60.0	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	46.5	75	93.1	150	62.1	58.6
	High Needs Students	40.7	75	81.4	150	54.2	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	49.8	75	66.4	100	66.4	61.4
	High Needs Students	43.4	75	57.8	100	57.8	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	60.4%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	65.2%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	37.6%	100%	18.8	50	37.6	64.9%
	Oral	45.7%	100%	22.8	50	45.7	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	30.4%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	40.3%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	83.2%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	32.6%	75%	21.7	50	43.4	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		78.8%	94%	41.9	50	83.8	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		89.6%	94%	95.3	100	95.3	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		87.2%	94%	92.7	100	92.7	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		59.4%	75%	79.2	100	79.2	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		83.3% 26.0%	75%	8.7	50	17.3	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		60.5%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	52.4%
Accountability Index				972.7	1550	62.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	58.4	45.0	13.4	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	52.9	40.7	12.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	57.1	43.4	13.7	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	87.2%	6.8%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	89.2
	High Needs Students	84.9
Math	All Students	89.2
	High Needs Students	84.9
Science	All Students	91.2
	High Needs Students	88.5

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.7

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Our district's improvement plans have focused on creating an equitable and rigorous educational experience for all of our students with an emphasis on student-centered classrooms.

The Student Services Department engaged in deep data collection to determine effectiveness of service delivery. We reorganized the implementation of our transition services in order to maximize students' opportunities to specially designed instruction related to transition skills. Our school psychology team engaged in training through CASP regarding appropriate evaluation techniques for students with diverse linguistic backgrounds as well. Some of our special education teachers participated in Wilson training to better meet the needs of our students with reading disabilities. We transitioned a dually certified TESOL and special education teacher to a specialized case management role for our dually-identified (EL and special education) students. We hired a speech language pathologist to provide direct services to our students (rather than requiring our partner districts to send their SLP to our campus.).

The grade-level support teams conducted student attendance conferences with students who were chronically absent, and when possible, their caregivers to discuss attendance related barriers and to create plans to remedy these barriers. These plans may include a referral to counseling or other services to assist in helping students to attend school regularly or daily morning check ins with a school counselor or social worker. Copies of these plans are given/sent home to the caregiver and placed in the student's file. NFA continued to partner with community agencies such as Norwich Youth and Family Services, the Department of Children and Families and Norwich Police Department to address barriers related to school attendance. We also helped to address student truancy response and prevention through our in-house Attendance Review Board. The NFA Foundation offered assistance to support school attendance-related barriers for students with housing instability.

To increase parental and community engagement in special education meetings, including PPTs, we maintained virtual format of meetings, resulting in a significant increase in parent participation. Faculty participated in training on diversity, equity and inclusion which included reflection on our own cultural identity and how it implicitly or explicitly affects our interactions with others. We learned strategies to become more culturally competent and to create a sense of belonging for our students and families. We held voluntary parent focus groups over the summer to gather feedback from and collaborate with our families on how to best support our students. In addition, we asked for parent input on developing our Portrait of a Graduate.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Director of Diversity participated in meetings sponsored by LEARN to develop a plan to recruit educators of color. In addition, 20 NFA students of color participated in LEARN's "Touch the Future" program which encourages students to leave a legacy by becoming an educator, to embrace diversity in education, and to find their voice and become young leaders.

In order to ensure all students had access to an electronic device to use at school, we created a Chromebook loan program for any student in need. Over the past three years, our Language Intervention Specialists assisted in delivering 75 Chromebooks to students' homes and explaining the purpose to many of our families who were not native English speakers. We expanded our outdoor WiFi on campus as well as partnered with Norwich Public Utilities and the Connecticut Education Network to create WiFi hotspots around Norwich to provide internet access to those in need.

The Wildcat Loft allows all students free access to clothing, hygiene products and school supplies regardless of need. Almost 2000 total transactions were conducted this school year. Similarly, the NFA Food Pantry exists to combat food insecurity for any NFA student. Food bags were sent home with approximately 50 students each week.

NFA participated in the statewide pilot of the new African American/Black and Puerto Rican/Latino Course of Studies.

We eliminated the remedial levels of our 9th grade core content area classes which traditionally had an overrepresentation of students of color.

Over 100 students participate in the following clubs focused on language and culture: Haitian Club, Cape Verdean Club, Successful Latino Alliance, Native American Group, Asian Culture Club, NAACP Youth Council, Muslim Club. Students of any background are invited and encouraged to join. In addition, we recognize and participate in the following cultural events either at NFA or in the Norwich Community: Haitian Flag Day, Hispanic Heritage Month, Cape Verdean Festival, Juneteenth Day, Martin Luther King Luncheon and March, Black History Month, NAACP Freedom fund Dinner.

The Slater Museum launched a Black History program in 2019 and partnered with the football coach to ensure that each player was able to experience it along with several other NFA classes.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwich Free Academy District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

NFA is a comprehensive independent high school that has a Master Educational Agreement with the Boards of Education from eight local Partner Communities. To that end, NFA is regarded as a single school district (one high school) that serves students from approximately twenty-one CT communities.